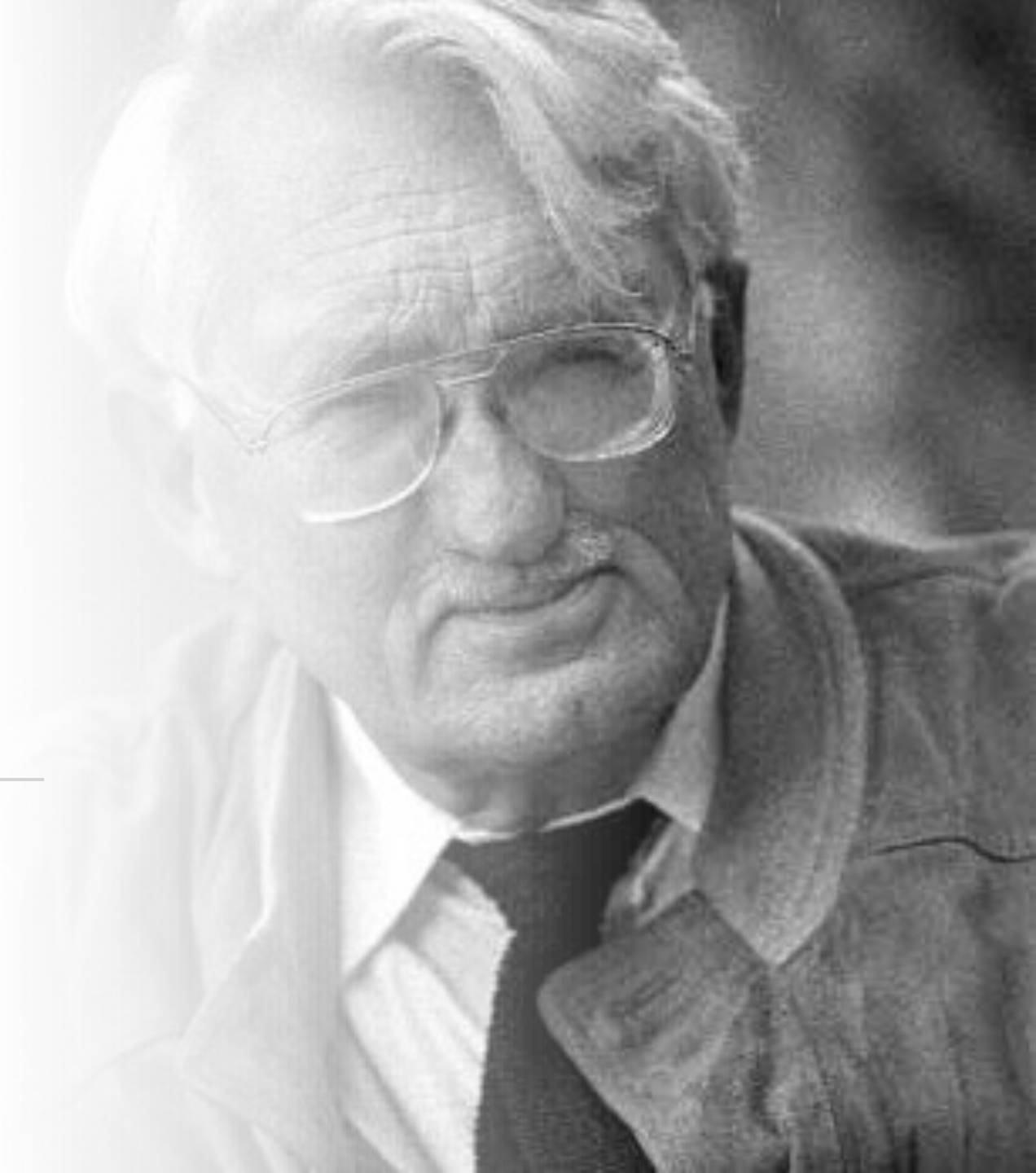
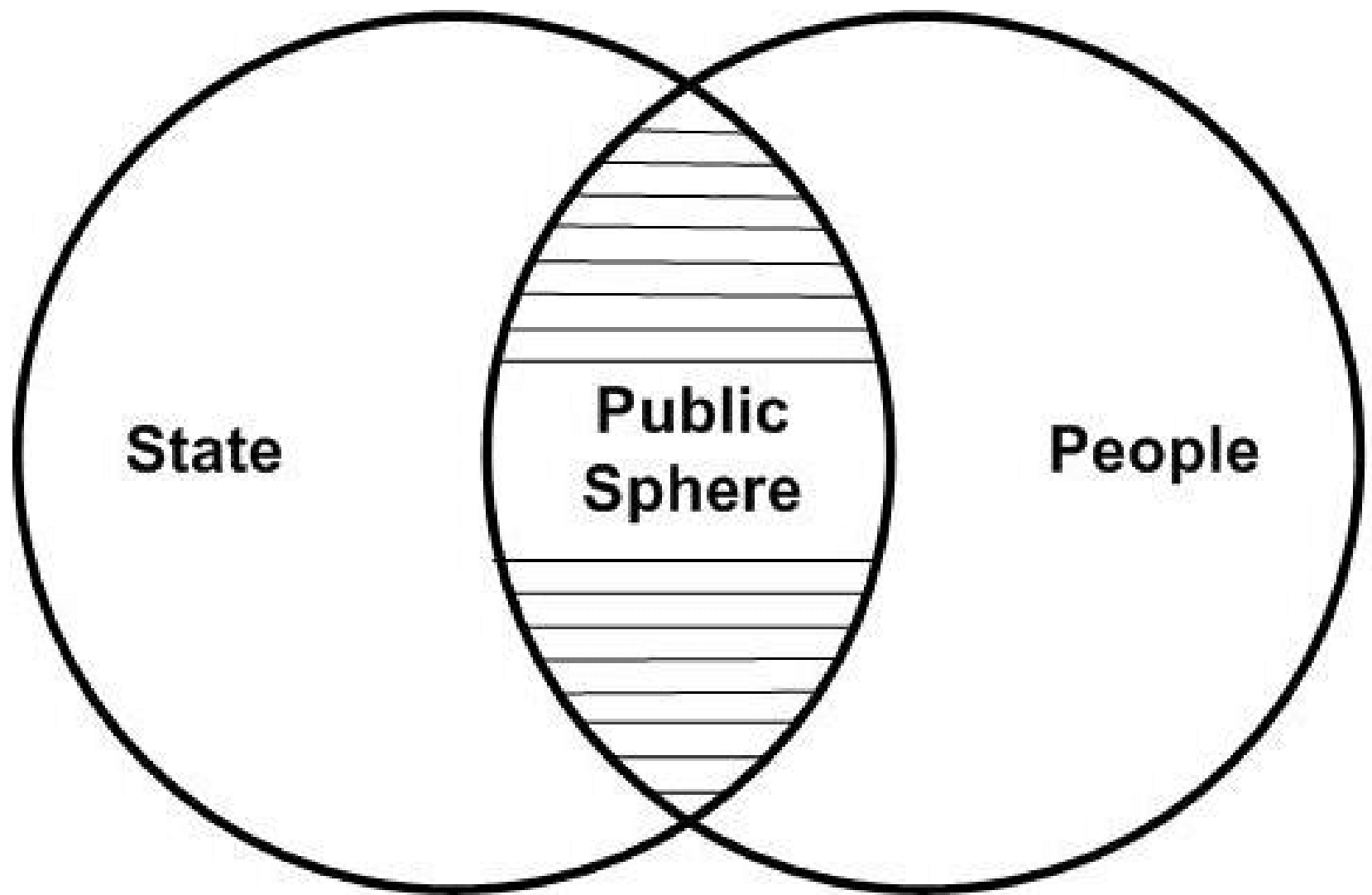


Lecture 13: Habermas and the Public Sphere



Jurgen Habermas (1929 -)







The Ideal Speech Situation



Anybody with the competence to speak be allowed to take part in a discussion



Anyone is allowed to question any assertion whatsoever in that discussion.



Anyone is allowed to introduce any assertion whatever into that discussion.



No person be prevented from exercising their rights to freedom of expression.



That the consensus of opinion be decided by the most rational argument.

Features of the public sphere

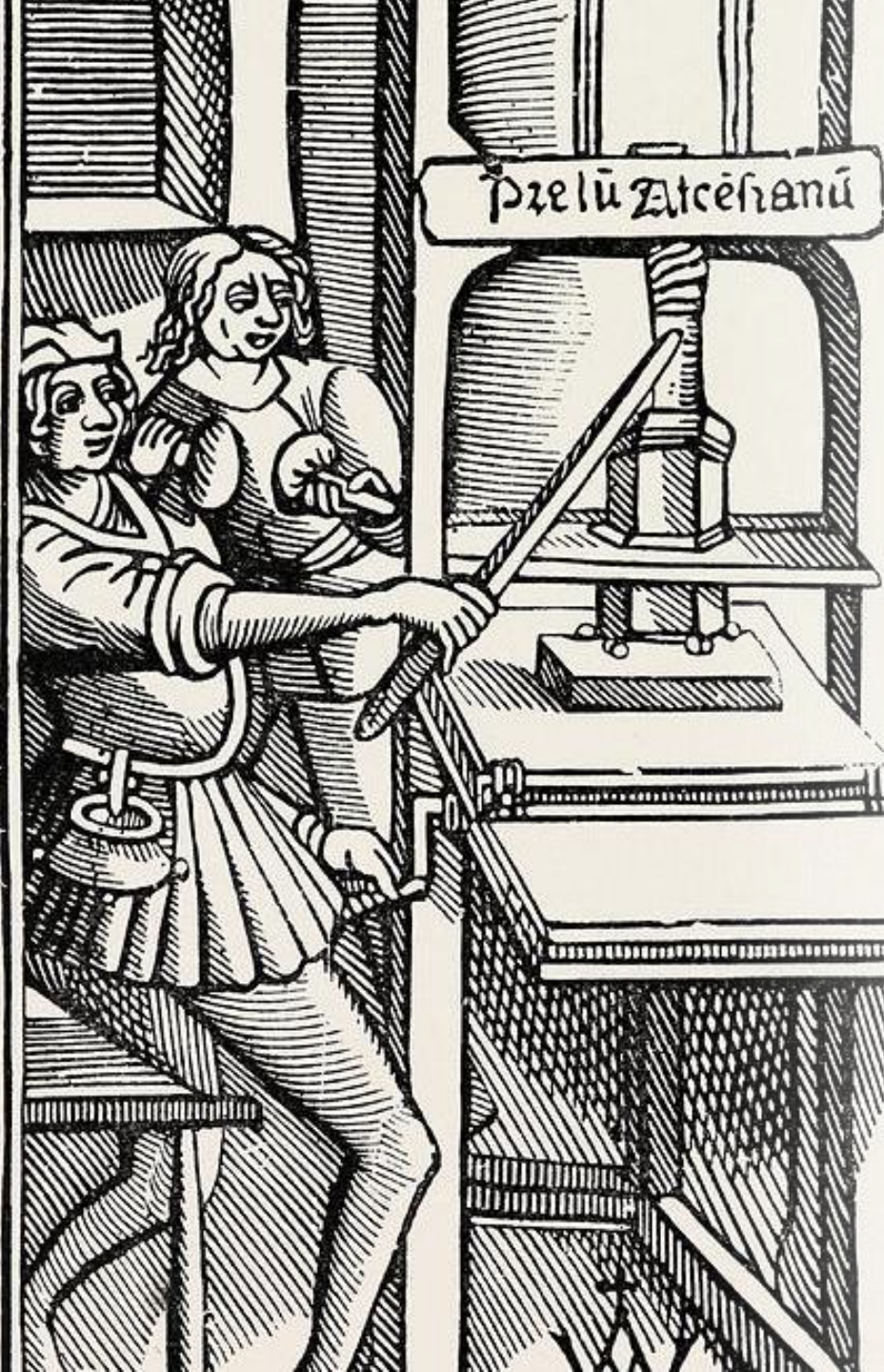
- ❖ Arena for, and a cumulative effect of, social discourse
- ❖ Democratic, in principle
- ❖ Communication that is distinct from the state and the market
- ❖ Individual members of society, through communicative interaction construct a social body



Example:
print
journalism



What did the public sphere look like in the 17th and 18th centuries?



The Emergence of the Press and Modern Journalism



The Fourth Estate



The Notion of Press Freedom

Per. Pub.
K

THE
POOR MAN'S GUARDIAN.
A Weekly Newspaper
FOR THE PEOPLE.

ESTABLISHED, CONTRARY TO "LAW," TO TRY THE
POWER OF "MIGHT" AGAINST "RIGHT."

No. 1. Saturday, July 9, 1831. [Price 1d.]

An emblem featuring a shield with a banner at the top that reads "KNOWLEDGE". Inside the shield is a printing press with a sheet of paper emerging from it, bearing the words "LIBERTY OF THE PRESS". At the bottom of the shield, the words "IS POWER" are written.

Rise of the Radical Press



The Decline of the Radical Press



Advertising and the Popular Press

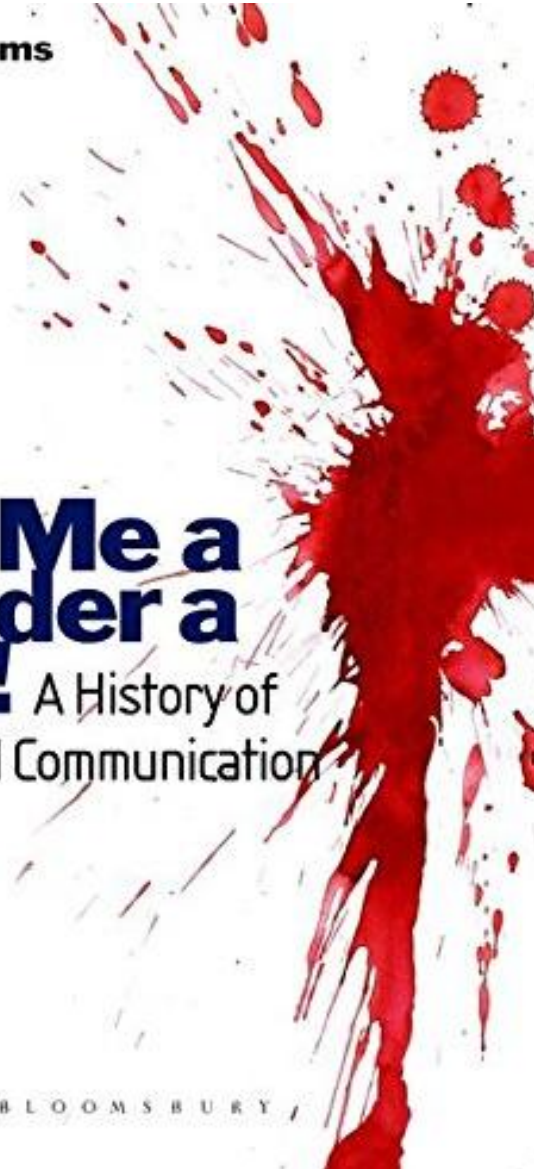
Kevin Williams

Get Me a Murder a Day!

A History of
Media and Communication
in Britain

SECOND EDITION

BLOOMSBURY

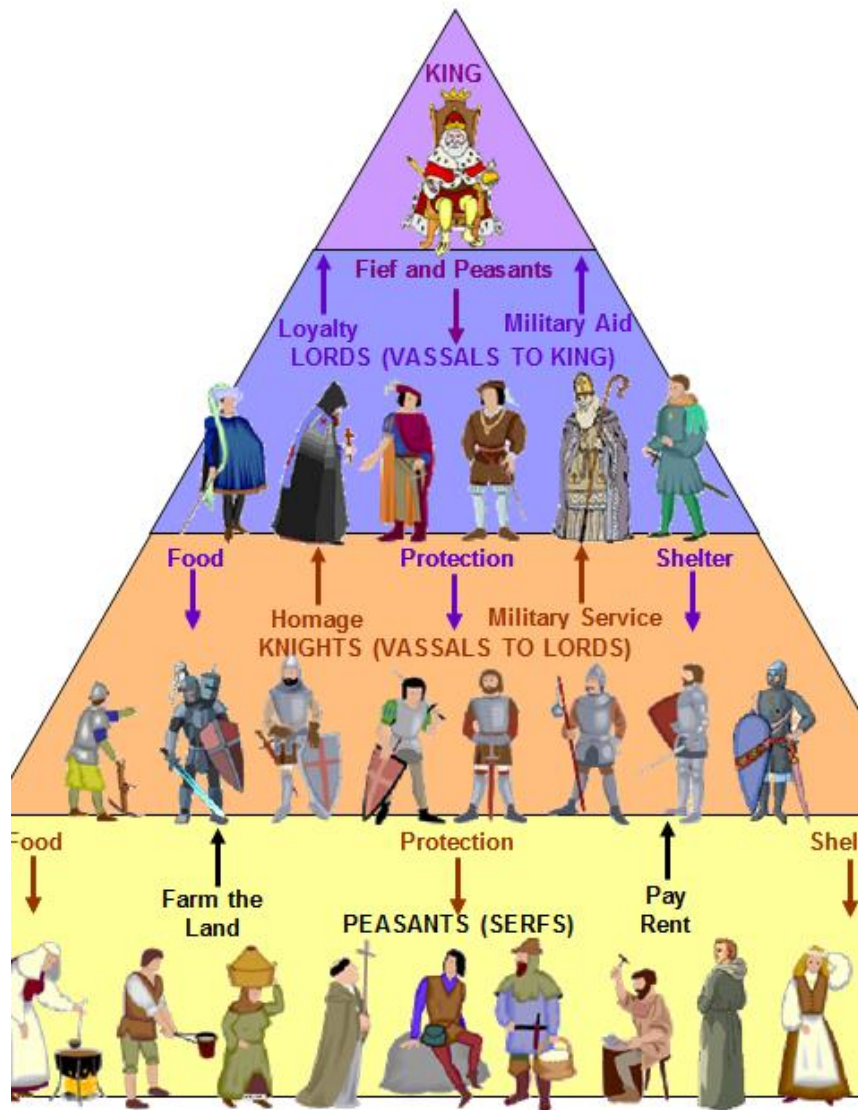




Press Barons and Concentration of Ownership

Tabloidisation of the Press in the late C20th





The Refeudalisation of the Public Sphere

Planet Murdoch

Leading News Corp interests

UK

- ▶ **The Sun**
- ▶ News of the World
- ▶ **The Sunday Times**
- ▶ The Times
- ▶ **TLS**
- ▶ TheLondonpaper
- ▶ **BSkyB**
- ▶ Sky News

Eastern Europe

- ▶ **BTV (Bulgaria)**
- ▶ Imedi Television (Georgia)
- ▶ **Radio Imedi (Georgia)**
- ▶ TV Puls (Poland)
- ▶ **B1 TV (Romania)**
- ▶ Fox Televizija (Serbia)

Asia

- ▶ **STAR TV**
- ▶ Tata Sky
- ▶ **Phoenix Television (Hong Kong/China)**

US

- ▶ **The New York Post**
- ▶ Dow Jones & Company
- ▶ **The Wall Street Journal**
- ▶ TV Guide
- ▶ **The Weekly Standard**
- ▶ MySpace
- ▶ **Fox Broadcasting Company**
- ▶ Fox News
- ▶ **20th Century Fox**

Italy

- ▶ Sky Italia

Fiji

- ▶ **Fiji Times (National)**
- ▶ Nai Lalakai
- ▶ **Shanti Dut**

Papa New Guinea

- ▶ Papua New Guinea Post-Courier

New Zealand

- ▶ **SKY Network Television**

Latin America

- ▶ **Sky Latin America**
- ▶ LAPTV
- ▶ **Saeta TV Channel 10 (Uruguay)**

Australia

- ▶ **The Australian**
- ▶ The Courier-Mail (Queensland)
- ▶ **The Sunday Mail (Queensland)**
- ▶ The Daily Telegraph

(New South Wales)

- ▶ **The Sunday Telegraph (New South Wales)**
- ▶ Herald Sun (Victoria)
- ▶ **Sunday Herald Sun (Victoria)**

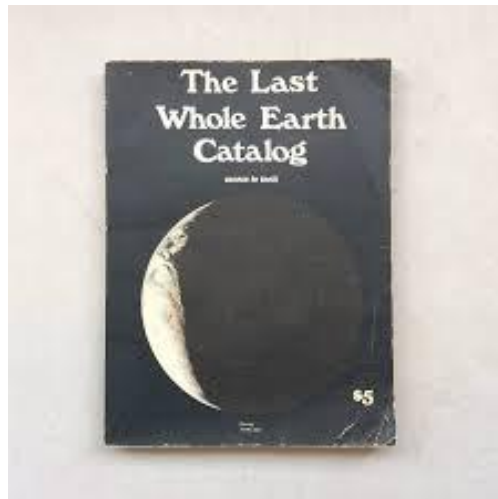
▶ The Advertiser (South Australia)

- ▶ **The Sunday Mail (South Australia)**
- ▶ GC (Australia)
- ▶ **Vogue (Australia)**
- ▶ **FOXTEL**



Example:
Social
Media

The promise of the internet and the 'Californian Ideology'



Social media ownership and control



Technofeudalism



Contemporary Relevance of the Idea of the Public Sphere

- Encourages us to focus on the relationship between the institutions and practices of the mass media and the institutions and practices of democratic politics, an object of study which has been relatively neglected in the field of media and communications studies since the so-called 'cultural turn' of the 1970s.
- Focuses our attention on the necessary material base required for genuinely public communication. This is especially important in an age where the means of mass communication are increasingly owned and monopolized by private interests and so-called media moguls. If such persons and organizations are to be challenged, we have to think about the necessary resources and regulatory environment in which a public sphere can flourish.
- Another merit to Habermas' public sphere is the conceptual space it opens up for a third model of media ownership, one that is neither dominated by state intervention or free market economics

Fraser's critique of the public sphere

Fraser, N. (1999) 'Rethinking the Public Sphere: A Contribution to the Critique of Actually Existing Democracy', During, S. (Ed.), *The Cultural Studies Reader*, London: Routledge, pp518-536.



Considering Fraser's argument

1. In what ways, if at all, are women, BAME people and trans / non-binary people excluded from the public sphere of social media?
2. What might be the 'subaltern counterpublics' for these groups?
3. Fraser insists that what counts as a matter of public concern is itself a political question? Do you agree?